

INDIA TODAY
INDO-JAPAN
CONCLAVE

Raj Chengappa, *Group Editorial Director (Publishing), India Today Group, with Delhi Lieutenant Governor* ***Sardar Taranjit Singh Sandhu*** *(right), and ambassador of Japan to India* ***Ono Keiichie*** *(left), at the* INDIA TODAY *Indo-Japan conclave, New Delhi, May 22*

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ON ON BOTH SIDES TO DEEPEN STRATEGIC, ECONOMIC AND CULTURAL ENGAGEMENT

merce and industry, Jitin Prasada, positioned India-Japan ties at the intersection of two defining themes shaping the world economy: technology and trade.

On the strategic front, Sujan R. Chinoy, director general of the Manohar Parrikar Institute for Defence Studies and Analyses (MP-IDSA) and a former ambassador of India to Japan, called for stronger India-Japan ties, suggesting that the relationship was boosted by India's emergence as an economic power and China's rising economic-military might and geopolitical assertion.

For the past three years, India has ranked among the most promising investment destinations for Japanese businesses, noted Takeshi Seo, India chairman of the Japan Chamber of Commerce and Industry, in the session on manufacturing. Echoing that optimism, Himanshu Srivastava, head, Japan Practice, Baker Tills ASA India LLP, said India is a hungry tiger and Japan a very experienced one. "What we need to do is walk together," he said. On the same theme, Hemant Pimplikar, MD, sales, FedEx, said what was critical is how we moved trade across the globe.

Shifting the focus to human capital, Debashree Mukherjee, secretary, Union ministry of skill development and entrepreneurship, made a case for reimagining the bilateral relationship not just through trade deals and technology partnerships, but through people.

On boosting investment, Fumio Yamazaki, minister of economy and development, Embassy of Japan in India, outlined two priorities. "One, to make the manufacturing industry successful in India. Another, the economic security where, given the world situation, the strengthening of the supply chain is primordial."

The discussions reflected a partnership widening in business, technology, infrastructure and culture. ■

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